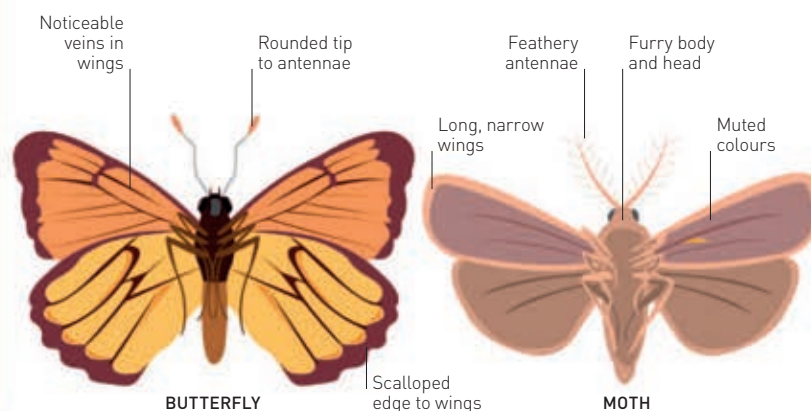


Butterflies and moths

With their delicate shape and often stunning colours, butterflies and moths are beautiful insects. All have four wings covered in tiny scales that create a mosaic of exquisite patterns. Most butterflies and moths feed on nectar from flowers and are important for pollinating plants.

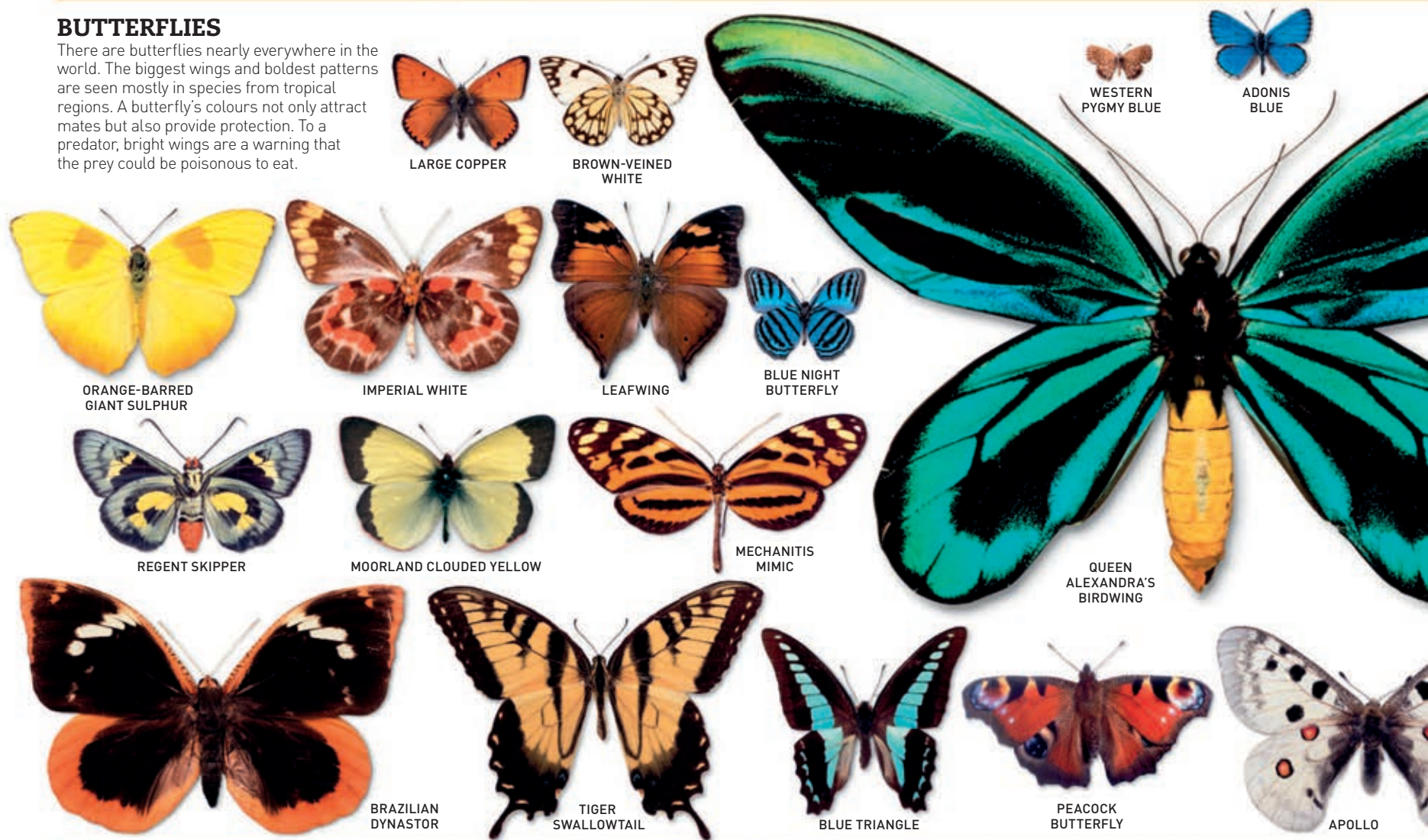
WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE?

Most butterflies fly by day and are brightly coloured. At rest, they usually fold their wings upright. Moths fly largely at night and most have duller colouring. They have furry bodies and feathery antennae. When resting, moths either hold their wings apart or fold them close to the body.



BUTTERFLIES

There are butterflies nearly everywhere in the world. The biggest wings and boldest patterns are seen mostly in species from tropical regions. A butterfly's colours not only attract mates but also provide protection. To a predator, bright wings are a warning that the prey could be poisonous to eat.



MOTHS

There are many more moths than butterflies. Most are less eye-catching, but spectacular species do occur. The gigantic moon moths can have wingspans of up to 30 cm (12 in).

